

BUSINESS OWNER CLIENT CHECKLIST

18 questions to help you talk about the business with confidence. Work through the four steps with any owner client: know the value, protect it, grow it, and reap it with a plan for the exit. Tick each item when you have a clear answer.

STEP 1 KNOW

Understand what the business is worth and what the owner needs.

- ☐ 01 Get an independent market valuation
- ☐ 02 Define the owner's number: after-tax proceeds needed for retirement
- ☐ 03 Clarify exit goals and timeline: sale, family, employees or keep
- ☐ 04 Know what buyers pay more for

STEP 2 PROTECT

Keep the value from disappearing when something changes.

- ☐ 05 Be financially prepared
- ☐ 06 Understand the hidden risk in your business
- ☐ 07 Secure key employees with documented roles, employment agreements and long-term incentives
- ☐ 08 Keep buy-sell and ownership agreements current, funded and formula-based
- ☐ 09 Test owner dependence: could the business run 90 days without the owner?
- ☐ 10 Two most common value killers: inconsistent revenue growth and personnel

STEP 3 GROW

Improve the drivers that raise value.

- ☐ 11 Develop a growth plan that accelerates business value
- ☐ 12 Connect key performance indicators (KPIs) to employee compensation plans
- ☐ 13 Manage expenses with vigilance
- ☐ 14 Measure what you manage

STEP 4 REAP

Plan for an exit with no regrets.

- ☐ 15 Evaluate your plan every six months
- ☐ 16 Line up your deal team early
- ☐ 17 Address personal transition matters
- ☐ 18 Align financial, personal and business readiness

WHY EACH ITEM MATTERS

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